Scudamore's Brand Guidelines

Last updated: 8 May 2026

About the brand

Scudamore's is **Cambridge's oldest punting company** — *punting gently down the Cam since 1910.*

Positioning

A quintessentially Cambridge experience on the river, built on over a century of craft and care for the Cam.

Brand goal

- **For locals**: *Where Cambridge goes punting*
- **For non-locals**: *Where Britain goes punting*

Audiences

- Tourists & visitors to Cambridge
- Locals & Cambridge residents
- Students & alumni
- Corporate & private hire clients
- Wedding & special occasion bookings
- B2B partnerships

In sum

To be the natural choice for punting.

Mission

To create timeless Cambridge memories.

Vision

- **Accessibility** — To make the pleasure of being on the water accessible to everybody, regardless of age, experience or ability.
- **Community** — To be the place where Cambridge comes to enjoy the river, whether for exercise, learning or relaxation.
- **Hospitality** — To act as ambassadors for Cambridge by giving our guests the best experience possible of our city.

Values

Heritage — *Founders and custodians* We are both the founders and custodians of punting in Cambridge, respecting the river and celebrating its rich heritage.

Experience — *Welcoming hosts* We act as courteous and attentive hosts, making our customers feel they are being introduced to the city by an informed friend.

Development — *Nurturing our people* We create the best environment for our people to develop their knowledge, skills and confidence in the pursuit of excellence.

Pioneering — *Responsible, Expert, Innovative*

- *Responsible*: Our story is intertwined with that of Cambridge itself, and we feel a strong sense of responsibility to our local community and the environment.
- *Expert*: Our immersion in Cambridge's culture and understanding of its history enables us to create tours that cover all the essentials, but also those little 'nice to know' details.
- *Innovative*: We're always exploring ways to improve the experiences we offer, from ergonomic boat seating, to children's activities, to bat safari wildlife tours.

Logo

Variations

We currently work with two primary logo files:

- **Solid (deep navy #14284b)** — for use on white, off-white or light backgrounds
- **White outline** — for use on navy/dark backgrounds and over photography (river scenes, punts, etc.)

Monochrome versions of the logo also exist and can be used where colour reproduction is limited (single-colour print, embroidery, etc.).

> **Rule of thumb**: use whichever variation gives the strongest contrast against its background. Legibility comes first.

Event & seasonal variations *(in development)*

We're exploring fun, event-specific takes on the logo for things like Bat Tours, Halloween, fireworks season, etc. These are not yet aligned — guidelines to follow once the team has agreed an approach. **Do not create one-off logo variations without sign-off.**

Clear space

The clear space around the logo flexes between **0.25x and 0.5x** of the logo height, depending on the design context:

- **0.5x (preferred)** — for standalone use, primary brand moments, hero imagery
- **0.25x (acceptable)** — for tight layouts, headers, or where space is genuinely constrained

When in doubt, give it more room. The logo should never feel crowded.

Minimum size

Use the following as a baseline — judge case-by-case and document exceptions:

- **Print**: minimum width **25mm**
- **Digital**: minimum width **90px**

Below these sizes, legibility starts to break down. If you need to go smaller (e.g. favicons, social avatars), consider whether an icon-only mark might serve better — and flag it for the team to review.

Logo don'ts *(suggested — confirm with team)*

- Don't recolour the logo outside the approved palette
- Don't stretch, skew or rotate the logo
- Don't add drop shadows, glows or other effects
- Don't place the solid logo on busy photography (use the white outline version)
- Don't reproduce the logo below minimum size

Colour palette

Primary

The brand rests on two anchors: **Deep Navy** (`#14284b`) and **Off-White** (`#fefefd`). Everything else extends from these.

Name	Alias	HEX	RGB	CMYK
Deep Navy	`navy-900`	`#14284b`	20 / 40 / 75	73 / 47 / 0 / 71
Off-White	`cream-50`	`#fefefd`	254 / 254 / 253	0 / 0 / 0 / 0

> The off-white is derived from the complementary of the navy — the two were designed as a pair.

Navy ramp — saturated

For backgrounds, dividers, secondary type, UI states, and everything in between. The ramp keeps saturation high (no greyed-out tints) so blues stay vivid.

Name	Alias	HEX	RGB	CMYK
Midnight	`navy-1000`	`#0a1530`	10 / 21 / 48	79 / 56 / 0 / 81
Deep Navy	`navy-900`	`#14284b`	20 / 40 / 75	73 / 47 / 0 / 71
Dusk	`navy-700`	`#26467d`	38 / 70 / 125	70 / 44 / 0 / 51
Cam Blue	`navy-500`	`#3d68b0`	61 / 104 / 176	65 / 41 / 0 / 31
Sky	`navy-300`	`#7e9bd5`	126 / 155 / 213	41 / 27 / 0 / 16
Mist	`navy-100`	`#c2d0ec`	194 / 208 / 236	18 / 12 / 0 / 7
Vapour	`navy-50`	`#e7edf8`	231 / 237 / 248	7 / 4 / 0 / 3

Cream ramp — warmer

For backgrounds, layered surfaces, premium print, and warmth in customer-facing comms.

Name	Alias	HEX	RGB	CMYK
Off-White	`cream-50`	`#fefefd`	254 / 254 / 253	0 / 0 / 0 / 0
Vellum	`cream-75`	`#fcfaf3`	252 / 250 / 243	0 / 1 / 4 / 1
Cream	`cream-100`	`#f8f3e3`	248 / 243 / 227	0 / 2 / 8 / 3
Ivory	`cream-200`	`#f0e8cf`	240 / 232 / 207	0 / 3 / 14 / 6
Parchment	`cream-300`	`#e6d9b3`	230 / 217 / 179	0 / 6 / 22 / 10
Stone	`cream-400`	`#d4c8a6`	212 / 200 / 166	0 / 6 / 22 / 17

Gold accent

A warm, restrained complement to the navy. Evokes lantern light on the river at dusk — works particularly well for fireworks, evening tours, and premium / wedding contexts.

Name	Alias	HEX	RGB	CMYK
Honey	`gold-300`	`#e3c277`	227 / 194 / 119	0 / 15 / 48 / 11
Lantern Gold	`gold-500`	`#c9a24a`	201 / 162 / 74	0 / 19 / 63 / 21
Brass	`gold-700`	`#9c7a2f`	156 / 122 / 47	0 / 22 / 70 / 39

Loose tour-product mood cues

Tour branding stays anchored to the master palette, but each product can lean into a mood:

- **Fireworks —** Deep Navy or Midnight backgrounds with Honey / Lantern Gold accents
- **Bat tours —** Midnight + Dusk with sparing use of Mist (twilight feel)
- **Weddings & private hire —** Cream / Vellum backgrounds with Brass and Deep Navy
- **Day tours —** Master palette: Off-White or Cream + Deep Navy

Accessibility — WCAG AA pairings

Use these as your safe defaults. Anything not on these lists must be checked manually before use in body copy.

Body text on dark backgrounds *(passes AA at all sizes)*

- Off-White, Vellum, Cream, Vapour, or Mist on **Midnight, Deep Navy, or Dusk**
- Lantern Gold or Honey on **Midnight or Deep Navy**

Body text on light backgrounds *(passes AA at all sizes)*

- Midnight, Deep Navy, or Dusk on **Off-White, Vellum, Cream, Ivory, Parchment, Stone, or Honey**
- Cam Blue on **Off-White, Vellum, or Vapour** (passes AA, near threshold — prefer Deep Navy for body)

Large text & UI only *(passes AA Large 3:1, not AA Normal — use for 18pt+ headings, big numbers, decorative type, icons)*

- Brass on Off-White, Vellum, Cream, Ivory
- Cam Blue on Mist, Parchment, Stone, Honey
- Sky on Deep Navy or Midnight (works well for subheadings on dark)
- Dusk on Lantern Gold

Never use these pairings

- Sky on Mist, Vapour, or Off-White
- Mist on Vapour or Off-White
- Cam Blue on Sky
- Honey on Cream
- Lantern Gold on Honey, Stone, or Brass
- Stone on Parchment

> Rule of thumb: for body copy, always pair a colour from the dark end (Midnight → Cam Blue) with one from the light end (Off-White → Stone, or Honey). Same-end pairings are decorative only.

Typography

Fonts

Gill Sans Bold — *Headline & display* Used for H1, H2, the brand name (especially in caps lockups), and emotive pull quotes. Carries the warmth and slight heritage character of the brand.

Inter — *Working type (subheads, body, UI, captions)* Pairs cleanly with Gill Sans: Inter is a contemporary neo-grotesque designed for screens, with excellent legibility at every size. Free, open-source, and works across print, web, Canva, Figma and Office.

> Pairing rationale: Gill Sans's humanist warmth carries the heritage; Inter's clarity carries the modern. Together they say "1910, still alive today."

Fallback stack (digital): `'Gill Sans', 'Gill Sans MT', Calibri, 'Trebuchet MS', sans-serif` for headlines; `Inter, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', sans-serif` for body.

> **Future upgrade path: Söhne (Klim Type Foundry).** If we ever want typography itself to do brand work — to signal a tier above "tourist business" toward "Cambridge institution" — Söhne is the considered upgrade from Inter. It descends from Akzidenz-Grotesk (the same lineage Gill Sans grew out of), so the pairing carries a meaningful conversation between two eras of sans-serif craft, directly mirroring "1910 + still alive today." Slightly warmer than Inter at body size, with five subfamilies (Buch, Breit, Schmal, Mono) for richer editorial range. Trade-offs: paid (~£160 basic license), not on Google Fonts, requires self-hosting on web. Inter remains the primary working font.

Hierarchy

Level	Font	Weight	Size (print pt)	Tracking	Line-height
H1 — Hero	Gill Sans	Bold	56pt	−2%	1.05
H2 — Section head	Gill Sans	Bold	36pt	−1%	1.15
H3 — Subhead	Inter	Semibold	22pt	0	1.3
H4 — Section label	Inter	Semibold	16pt	0	1.4
Eyebrow / overline	Inter	Medium	12pt UPPERCASE	+15%	1.4
Body large / intro	Inter	Regular	18pt	0	1.6
Body default	Inter	Regular	15pt	0	1.6

Level	Font	Weight	Size (print pt)	Tracking	Line-height
Caption / small	Inter	Regular	12pt	0	1.5
Pull quote	Gill Sans	Bold Italic	24pt	0	1.4

For digital, scale these proportionally (e.g. H1 hero → 48–64px depending on viewport; body → 16px). Maintain the same proportional relationships.

Casing rules

- **Sentence case** is the default for almost everything — headlines, subheads, body. This carries the warm, approachable customer-facing tone.
- **ALL CAPS** is reserved for:
  - The brand name **SCUDAMORE'S** when it appears with the logo or as a brand stamp
  - Eyebrow / overline labels above a headline
  - Section dividers in long-form layouts
- **Title Case** is avoided for headings (feels corporate). Fine for proper nouns and tour names (e.g. "Bat Safari Tour").

> Caps are a feature, not the default. Use them where they earn their keep.

Tracking (letter-spacing) rules

Context	Tracking
Hero / display headlines (40pt+)	−2% (−20 in 1000 units)
Mid display (24–40pt)	−1% (−10 in 1000 units)
Body, UI, subheads	0 (defaults)
Anything in caps (brand name, eyebrows, dividers)	+15% (+150 in 1000 units)

Tighter tracking on big type makes headlines feel confident and intentional. Generous tracking on caps prevents the letters from running into each other.

Numerals

Use **tabular (monospaced) figures** for any context where numbers need to align vertically or be compared at a glance:

- Prices and pricing tables
- Dates, times, schedules
- Phone numbers

- Data tables and statistics
- Receipts, invoices, booking confirmations

Use **proportional figures** (the default) for numbers that appear inline in prose — they read more naturally and don't draw the eye away from the words around them.

> In Inter and most modern fonts, tabular figures are accessed via the OpenType `tnum` feature. In Canva and Office, this often appears as "lining figures" / "tabular" in the font's number-style menu. If unsure, eyeball it: do the columns of digits line up? They should.

Links & hyperlinks

Context	Style
Inline in body copy (web)	Lantern Gold (`#c9a24a`), no underline at rest, **underline on hover**
Standalone link (footer, nav, button-like)	Lantern Gold, **underline always**
Visited links (web)	Brass (`#9c7a2f`), same underline behaviour
Print	Underline only — no colour change required
On dark backgrounds	Honey (`#e3c277`) instead of Lantern Gold for contrast

> Rule of thumb: colour alone is not sufficient for WCAG. If a link is the only one on a line and might be missed, underline it. If it sits within a sentence where context makes it obvious (e.g. *"read more on our [tours page]"*), the colour shift + hover underline is enough.

Lists

- **Bulleted lists**: use a small dot bullet (`•`) or simple en-dash (`–`) for visual rhythm
- **Numbered lists**: use the font's lining figures (1., 2., 3.) — never circled or boxed numerals
- **Spacing**: 0.4em hanging indent so wrapped lines align with the first character of text, not the bullet
- **Length**: lists over ~6 items become hard to scan — split into groups or rewrite as prose

Quotes & apostrophes

Always use **'curly' / 'smart' quotes and apostrophes** — never `'straight'` ones. Most software (Word, Canva, Google Docs) does this automatically; check that smart quotes are switched on.

- Single quotes for titles within sentences and quoted speech
- Double quotes for direct testimonials and pull quotes
- The brand name's apostrophe must always be curly: **Scudamore's**, never Scudamore's

House style

Spelling

- British English throughout: *colour, organisation, harbour, recognise, towards, whilst*
- Oxford comma is optional — use it where it aids clarity, omit where it doesn't (consistency within a single piece is more important than universal rule)

Emphasis

- *Italic* for emphasis only — never for titles of works (which we treat as proper nouns: e.g. The Cambridge Companion to Punting). Tour names sit in regular type with capital initials (Bat Safari Tour, Fireworks Punting Evening).
- **Bold** sparingly, for genuine emphasis or UI labels — never to "decorate" body copy
- **Small caps** for est. dates, abbreviations like BC/AD, and stylistic moments where ALL CAPS would shout (e.g. EST. 1910 → est. 1910 in small caps)

Punctuation

- **Em dashes (—)** with spaces around them — like this — used freely. They're warmer than parentheses and more confident than a comma.
- **Ampersand (&)** only when space-constrained (signage, narrow column UI, navigation). Default is "and" in running prose.
- **Ellipses** as a single character (…), not three dots (...)
- **Apostrophes**: curly (’), never straight (')

Numbers in prose

- Spell out one to nine; numerals from 10 onwards
- Always numerals for ages, prices, times, dates, percentages
- Use a non-breaking space between number and unit: 25 mm, 90 px, £25 (this prevents awkward line breaks)

Brand voice

How Scudamore's sounds

The voice draws straight from the values: welcoming, nurturing, responsible, expert. It's the voice of someone who has been on this river for a hundred-plus years and doesn't need to make a fuss about it.

Voice traits

Warm — like an informed friend showing you their city We sound like the friend who actually lives in Cambridge — the one who knows the best spots, the quiet routes, the stories behind the colleges. Not a tour guide. Not a brochure.

> *"Wrap up warm — the Cam holds the cold long after the air's turned. There'll be blankets in the punt."*

Quietly confident — we've been doing this since 1910, we don't need to shout We don't claim. We mention. The heritage is the bedrock; we don't have to keep tapping on it. No exclamation marks doing work that the words should do themselves.

> *"Cambridge's oldest punting company. Founded 1910, family-run ever since."*

Knowledgeable — we know our river, our city, our craft We name the colleges. We know which bridges are which. We can tell you why the punt is flat-bottomed and which way to face. Specificity is a love language.

> *"Stop on the Bridge of Sighs side and you'll see the wisteria coming through in late May."*

Unfussy — plainspoken, no jargon, no sales-speak Short sentences. Plain words. We say "punt," not "vessel." We say "trip," not "experience." If a sentence sounds like a brochure, we cut it.

> *"Two hours on the Cam, a chauffeur who knows the river, and a flask of something warm if it's chilly. £95."*

Playful — there's a twinkle, especially in moments where it earns its keep We're not stiff. The right joke at the right moment lands warmer than any heritage line. But we're never trying too hard — the playfulness is dry, occasional, and confident enough not to push.

> *"Yes, you can fall in. No, you almost certainly won't."*

The Scudamore's voice — anchored

If a single line had to capture it: **"Where Cambridge goes punting."**

Anchored. Declarative. Locals-first. It says everything in four words: we're the trusted, established choice; we're for Cambridge before we're for anyone else; punting is a verb here, not a product.

The sniff test

Before publishing, ask: **"Could a competitor publish this sentence verbatim?"** If yes, rewrite it. The voice should be unmistakably Scudamore's — specific where they're generic, calm where they're loud, knowledgeable where they're keyword-stuffed.

Be mindful of

Not banned, but flagged for a closer look — these are the patterns that drift the voice toward generic tourism-brand or AI-generated copy.

Competitor / generic-tourism phrasing

- *"Let's go punting"* — that's a competitor's name (Let's Go Punting Cambridge). Reword.

- *"Glide along the river"* — generic, used everywhere.
- *"Cam River"* — it's **the Cam** or **the River Cam**. Never *Cam River*.
- *"Traditional chauffeured punting tour"* — fine for SEO; in actual writing, find a fresher phrasing.

Patterns that read like AI or marketing-speak

- Sentences that could appear word-for-word on a competitor's site.
- The hedged, even-paragraph-shape rhythm of generic AI copy.
- Stacked adjectives: *"a stunning, beautiful, unforgettable Cambridge experience"* — pick one, or none.
- *"Proud to announce / partner with / offer..."* — just say it. The pride is implicit.
- *"We hope you'll join us!"* / *"We'd love it if you considered..."* — apologetic over-explaining. State the offer.
- Performative inclusivity language that doesn't match how we actually talk.
- ALL CAPS for emphasis (caps are reserved for the brand name and overlines — see typography).

Tourism cliches *(use sparingly and with intent — never as a default) Unforgettable, iconic, authentic, hidden gem, bucket-list, once-in-a-lifetime, magical, step back in time, timeless tradition.* These aren't forbidden — sometimes one is exactly the right word. The test: are you reaching for it because it's true and specific here, or because it's the easiest tourism-brand reach?

Marketing-speak abstractions *(use when accurate, not as filler) Curated, bespoke, premium, elevated, immersive, journey, experience, unparalleled.* We genuinely curate and we genuinely run bespoke private hires. When those words are accurate, use them. When they're filler dressing up something simpler, cut them.

Scudamore's-isms — house vocabulary

> 🟡 **To discuss with the team.** This section captures the words and phrasings we use a particular way — *the Cam* not *Cam River*, *chauffeur* vs *guide* vs *driver*, *punt* vs *boat*, naming specific colleges rather than "the colleges," etc. Before locking in, the team should review what we already do consistently and decide what's house style. Add agreed terms below.

[Awaiting team alignment]

Tone variations by channel

Voice stays constant. Tone flexes by context — slightly warmer for an evening newsletter, slightly more functional for a booking confirmation, slightly more playful for internal Slack.

Channel	Tone	Sample
Website hero	Anchored, evocative, declarative	*Where Cambridge goes punting. Founded 1910, family-run since.*
Tour-product page	Warm, knowledgeable, specific	*Two hours on the Cam with a chauffeur who knows the river. We'll start at Mill Lane and turn at the Bridge of Sighs — by then the colleges are catching the light, and you'll see why we've been doing this for a hundred years.*
Booking confirmation email	Quietly confident, useful, friendly	*You're booked. Saturday 14 June, 6pm, Mill Lane. Wrap up warm — the Cam holds the cold long after the air's turned. Any questions, just reply.*
Newsletter	Warm, slow, evocative	*The May Balls have started. From the river, you can see the marquee lights catching on the water before you can hear the music. We've put together a few evenings — fireworks tours, late-summer drifts, the bat safari coming back at the end of June.*
Instagram caption	Playful, specific, light	*Punt no. 17, taken out for her first run of the season this morning. She's been with us since 1962 and she's still the prettiest in the yard.*
Customer service reply	Plainspoken, generous, calm	*Sorry to hear that — let's sort it out. Could you send over your booking reference and I'll find you in the system?*
Internal / team Slack	Playful, retro, dry	*Right, fireworks rota's up. Three evenings, four chauffeurs, one flask of tea per boat. Speak now or forever pretend you didn't see this.*
B2B / partnerships	Professional, warm, plainspoken	*We work with about twenty colleges and a handful of corporate partners on private hire. Happy to send through what we typically offer for groups your size.*

Photography

Visual personality

A mix — we shoot whatever the day gives us. The unifying factor is the **edit**, not a single look. Some days the Cam is mist and dusk; some days it's hard sun on King's Chapel. Both are Scudamore's. The job of every shoot and every edit is to make the variety feel like one body of work.

> Our experiences are picturesque enough that the edit should disappear. If a photo looks "edited," we've gone too far.

Editing & colour grade

- **Natural** — minimal colour grading, true to what the eye saw on the day
- Slight lifts to **saturation** and **contrast** are fine where the image needs them
- **No heavy filters, no fashion-style colour grades, no "tourism teal-and-orange"** — this looks processed and dates fast
- White balance should be honest to the time of day (golden hour stays warm; overcast stays cool — don't fight the weather)

If a photo needs heavy editing to work, the shoot was the problem — reshoot rather than rescue.

Composition

We use whatever composition serves the moment — off-centre, negative space, tight detail crops, wide environmental shots, symmetrical reflections. No single rule. But two practical principles do hold:

- **Shoot wide, crop in.** Always shoot too wide and at the highest quality the kit allows. Cropping in (or AI up-rezzing later) is far easier than missing the frame. Tight-shot-only material is a frequent regret on social and banners.
- **Capture every key shot in both formats.** Wide / horizontal *and* tall / vertical. Banners, web heroes and YouTube need horizontal; Instagram, posters, TikTok, Reels need vertical. If a shot only exists in one ratio, it's only half-useful.

Aspect ratios — required formats

Use	Ratio	Notes
Web hero, banner, YouTube thumbnail	16:9 horizontal	Shoot wide, crop after
Instagram feed, square posts	1:1	Often a centre-crop of the horizontal
Instagram Stories, Reels, TikTok, posters	9:16 vertical	Shoot deliberately, not by rotating the horizontal
Print poster (A-series)	~√2 vertical (A2/A3)	Shoot vertical with crop margin
Email header	3:1 horizontal	Crop from the widest take

Rule: every key shot should exist in **horizontal AND vertical** masters. If it doesn't, schedule a reshoot.

General guidelines

- **Light**: natural where possible. Golden hour and the hour after sunrise are the highest-value windows on the Cam.
- **Weather**: don't only shoot the blue-sky days. Mist, rain on the water, autumn leaves, frost on the punts — these are where the most distinctive Scudamore's images come from.
- **Movement**: the Cam is a moving thing. Static, posed shots feel like stock; capture the punt mid-stroke, water trailing off the pole, ripples breaking the reflection.
- **Specificity**: name the location in the metadata — *Bridge of Sighs from the river, evening light* — not just *"Cambridge"*. Helps everyone who needs to find an asset later.

Subject — people

What we capture:

- Customers visibly enjoying themselves — candid laughter, conversation, the pole hand-off moment
- Chauffeurs at work — mid-pole-stroke, the craft, hands and stance
- Quiet moments — fingers trailing in the water, a couple looking out, a child watching a duck
- Group dynamics — families, friends, wedding parties, the social side of a punt
- Anonymous figures — silhouettes, back-of-head shots, hands-only — subject-but-not-identifiable

On the shoot itself:

- We typically use **staff as models** for marketing shoots
- The photographer / videographer is responsible for capturing **everyone's best side**. If lighting, angle, or styling can't deliver this for someone on the day, that person doesn't go on the shoot. This is a kindness to the team and a quality bar for the brand.
- **Wardrobe direction**: be deliberate about what talent wears. A pop of colour that stands out from the river palette (a red coat, a yellow jumper, a mustard scarf) lifts a shot enormously. Avoid logos that compete with our own, busy patterns, and anything that dates fast.
- **Bring blankets, flasks, props.** A lot of the warmth in our best shots comes from these small details.

Consent & identifiable people

> ⚠️ **Treat this section as our working understanding, not legal advice.** When in doubt — particularly around children, weddings, or partnership content — get sign-off from someone qualified before publishing.

Default rules:

- **Chauffeurs and staff** are photographed in detail. Their employment contract should cover image rights for company marketing — confirm with HR that current contracts do, or use a one-off signed release.
- **Customers** are photographed anonymously by default (back-of-head, silhouettes, hands, wide environmental shots). The river is a public space and incidental presence is fine, but commercial use of clearly identifiable customers requires consent.
- **Identifiable customer shots**: if we want to use an image where a customer is the clear subject, we ask on the day and get a signed release form covering name, date, image reference, and scope of use ("Scudamore's marketing in perpetuity, all channels").
- **Children**: anyone under 18 needs parental/guardian consent for commercial use. Anyone under 13 cannot consent themselves at all. If we don't have explicit parental consent, we don't publish.

The subject vs background test: *Would a reasonable person looking at this image identify themselves as the focus?* If they're one of fifteen people on the water — incidental, fine. If they're the smiling couple at the centre of the frame — subject, needs consent.

Storage: keep all signed releases on file with the corresponding image reference. Under UK GDPR, anyone has the right to request their image is removed — we need to be able to find the record.

Subject — products & objects

The "products" are the punts themselves and everything that goes with them.

- **Hero shots**: a guided tour at Bridge of Sighs or behind King's College Chapel; or a self-hire punt on the same stretches. These are the highest-volume marketing assets — invest in getting them right.
- **The punts**: woodgrain, seats, prow, the lines they leave on the water
- **The kit**: poles, cushions, blankets, flasks — the small details that make a Scudamore's trip
- **The boatyard / Mill Lane**: the working heart of the operation
- **Heritage detail**: brass fittings, painted name on the prow, signage
- **Empty-punt-on-water**: atmospheric, no people, often the strongest at dawn or dusk

Subject — places

The Cambridge we show:

- **Hero shots** for high-volume marketing: **King's College Chapel** and the **Bridge of Sighs**, both seen from the river
- **The colleges** named and recognisable — King's, Trinity, St John's, Clare, Queens'

- **The bridges** named — Mathematical Bridge, Bridge of Sighs, Magdalene Bridge, Clare Bridge
- **The river itself** — reflections, ripples, weather on the water, weeping willows, swans, ducks
- **Hidden Cambridge** — quieter stretches, the Backs in winter, dawn on the Cam, late dusk
- **The wider city** — Mill Lane, market square, streets seen from the water
- **The seasons & wildlife** — bats at dusk, ducklings in spring, autumn leaves on the Cam, frost on the punts

> Heroes are about **recognisability**. Everything else is about **range** — the Cambridge people don't see on a postcard.

Graphics & icons

Illustration

> 🟡 **Placeholder — to define.** We use illustration occasionally but don't have a documented style. Until we do, illustration commissions and uses should be reviewed case-by-case to make sure they feel like Scudamore's.

When we do use illustration, the working principles are:

- **Photography does the heavy lifting** — illustration supplements, it doesn't replace
- **Heritage-leaning, not generic-modern** — we'd rather lean into hand-drawn warmth (engraved / etched / linocut feel) than flat vector clip-art
- **Two-tone where possible** — Deep Navy + Cream, or Deep Navy + Lantern Gold, keeps illustrations on-brand without competing with photography

A defined style is a follow-up — see *Follow-ups* at the end of this document.

Vintage & archive imagery

We have a strong heritage and benefit from using archival material — postcards, old photographs, illustrations, posters from across our 100+ years on the Cam. Where we hold the rights or can license cleanly, vintage imagery is one of the most distinctive assets the brand has.

- **Rights first** — never use archival material we don't have explicit rights to
- **Treat respectfully** — archive images can be reproduced at print quality, captioned with date and context, and shouldn't be cropped to lose visible historical context
- **Pair, don't paste** — vintage imagery works best alongside contemporary photography (the conversation between then and now is the point), not as standalone decoration

> A rights audit of our archive material is a follow-up — see end of document.

Icons

We don't yet have a single icon system. Current state: Bootstrap and Lucide (React) on the website (via shadcn), Bootstrap and Phosphor in Figma, plus a handful of custom punting icons that vary between solid and outlined.

Recommended approach — pick one primary system and use it consistently. Bespoke icons are reserved for things that don't exist in standard libraries (specific punt diagrams, Cambridge landmarks, our own seasonal events).

Approved icon libraries:

Library	Best for	Notes
Lucide	Web / product UI	Already in use via shadcn; minimal, geometric, free
Phosphor	Marketing, Figma, decorative use	Multiple weights (thin → bold → fill), more character
Tabler	Dashboards, dense UI, admin	~5800 icons, free, outline-only
Bootstrap Icons	Web fallback / legacy	Already in use; keep until consolidating
Bespoke	Punting-specific, business-specific	Punt, pole, chauffeur stance, college icons, seasonal events

Style rules (working draft — to formalise):

- **Outline by default** — solid fills only when an icon needs to read at very small sizes or carry semantic weight (e.g. a filled bookmark vs an outline bookmark)
- **Consistent weight within a piece** — don't mix Phosphor Thin and Phosphor Bold in the same layout
- **Sizing** — 16px (UI inline), 20px (default), 24px (touch targets, decorative inline), 32px+ (feature blocks)
- **Colour** — Deep Navy by default; Lantern Gold for accent / interactive states; Off-White on dark backgrounds
- **Stroke width** — 1.5–2px for outline icons at standard sizes; never below 1px

> A bespoke icon set covering punting, Cambridge landmarks, and Scudamore's-specific concepts is a follow-up — see end of document.

Decorative elements

We keep things clean — heavy decoration would fight the heritage feel and the photography. But a small, consistent set of decorative devices can elevate layouts without crowding them.

Approved (working draft):

- **Hairline rules** — 0.5px Deep Navy lines for dividing text, separating sections, framing photo captions. Never thicker than 1px.
- **Lantern Gold accent rule** — a short (40–60mm) horizontal Lantern Gold line under section labels or eyebrow text for editorial moments
- **The "est. 1910" lockup** — a small text mark using small caps that can sit alongside the logo on heritage-led pieces
- **Watermark / stamp** — the icon-only logo at low opacity (10–15%) for letterhead, certificates, or formal documents

Avoid:

- Heavy borders or frames around content
- Decorative flourishes (curls, scrolls, ornaments) — this dates fast and competes with the heritage type
- Rounded badges with text inside ("Since 1910!" in a circle) — fine for fun moments only, never as default brand decoration
- Drop shadows, glows, gradients on text or shapes — these fight the flat, calm aesthetic

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Charts & data visualisation

We use charts across internal reports, board decks, operational dashboards, B2B pitch decks, press/PR, proposals, and external impact reports. The visual approach is **minimal and editorial** — closer to FT or Economist than to a default Excel chart. Most of the time, less colour is more.

Where we use shadcn default charts on the website / product, those are the visual baseline — restrained, clean, well-defaulted — and the brand palette extends them rather than replacing them.

The default chart

A Scudamore's chart, by default, looks like this:

- **Single colour: Deep Navy (#14284b)** for the data
- **No chart border, no chart title rendered in the chart itself** — the title sits in surrounding type using the Typography hierarchy (H3 or H4)
- **No gridlines**, or pale gridlines on the y-axis only (Mist `#c2d0ec` at low opacity)
- **Axis labels and tick labels** in Dusk (`#26467d`), 11–12pt, Inter Regular
- **Data labels** only when they aid comprehension; never as decoration
- **Generous whitespace** around the plot area
- **Source line** beneath the chart, in Caption style (Inter Regular 12pt, Dusk colour)

If the chart can be read clearly with just one colour, use one colour. Add more only when the data genuinely requires distinction.

When more colour is needed

Need	Approach
Highlighting one data point in a series	Keep the rest Deep Navy; make the highlighted point **Lantern Gold (** `#c9a24a`**)**
Sequential / ordered data (e.g. quarters in a year, age brackets)	Use the navy ramp: Deep Navy → Dusk → Cam Blue → Sky → Mist
Categorical data (up to 4 categories)	Deep Navy, Lantern Gold, Cam Blue, Stone — in that priority order
Categorical data (5+ categories)	Reconsider whether all categories need to show — group "Other" if you can. If you must show all, extend with: Deep Navy, Lantern Gold, Cam Blue, Stone, Brass, Sky
Diverging data (positive vs negative, e.g. NPS)	Cam Blue for positive, Brass for negative, Stone for neutral
Comparisons (us vs competitor, this year vs last)	Deep Navy for "us / this year"; Mist or Stone for "them / last year"

> Rule of thumb: when in doubt, use one colour. The story should come from the data, not from the colours.

Chart types — when to use each

Line charts — for change over time. The default for revenue, bookings, occupancy, growth metrics. Use a single Deep Navy line; add a second line in Lantern Gold only when comparing two series. Avoid more than two lines on one chart unless absolutely necessary — split into small multiples instead.

Bar charts (vertical) — for comparing values across discrete categories where the categories have a natural order (months, quarters, tour types). Single colour by default. Use Lantern Gold to highlight a single bar (e.g. "this month" or "the highest performer").

Bar charts (horizontal) — for comparing values across categories where the labels are long (customer feedback themes, source-of-booking, college names). Easier to read than vertical when you have more than ~6 categories.

Stacked bar charts — for showing parts of a whole *across* categories (e.g. tour-type breakdown by month). Use the navy ramp sequentially — Deep Navy at the bottom, lighter tints as you stack up.

Pie & donut charts — use sparingly, and only when there are **3 or fewer slices**. For more than 3, use a horizontal bar chart instead. If you must use a donut, put the most important number (total, headline figure) in the centre.

Heatmaps — for two-dimensional data like occupancy by day-of-week × hour-of-day, or weather impact across the season. Use a single-hue ramp (Vapour → Mist → Cam Blue → Deep Navy → Midnight). Light = low, dark = high.

Maps — for geographic data (where customers come from). Use the navy ramp as a choropleth (lighter for low values, darker for high). UK and Cambridge city maps preferred over generic world projections.

Gauges / single-stat callouts — for headline numbers in dashboards. Big number in Gill Sans Bold (or Inter Semibold for working dashboards), Deep Navy, with a small delta (▲/▼) in Cam Blue (positive) or Brass (negative) below.

Avoid: 3D charts, exploded pie slices, any chart with a drop shadow or gradient fill, "speedometer" gauges with multi-colour bands, anything where the chart's decoration outweighs its data.

Typography in charts

Element	Font	Size	Colour
Chart title (above chart)	Gill Sans Bold or Inter Semibold	H3 or H4 size	Deep Navy
Subtitle / context	Inter Regular	14pt	Dusk
Axis labels	Inter Medium	12pt	Dusk
Tick labels	Inter Regular (tabular figures)	11pt	Dusk
Data labels	Inter Medium (tabular figures)	11pt	Deep Navy
Legend	Inter Regular	12pt	Dusk
Source line	Inter Regular	11pt	Cam Blue

Always use tabular figures for any number rendered in a chart — they align cleanly across rows and columns and stop the eye snagging on inconsistent widths.

Always include

- **A clear title** (in surrounding type, not inside the chart)
- **Axis labels with units** (e.g. *Bookings (thousands)* not just *Bookings*)
- **A source** if data comes from anywhere other than internal Scudamore's records
- **The date or period** the data covers

The honesty rules

- **Y-axis starts at zero** for bar charts, always. Truncating the axis to exaggerate change is misleading.
- **Pie chart slices add to 100%** — don't omit "Other" silently
- **Don't dual-axis** unless the two scales are genuinely related (e.g. revenue and bookings on the same time axis). If you have to explain why two axes share a chart, they shouldn't.
- **Round consistently** — don't show 47.3% next to 51% in the same chart

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Brand applications

This section is the **"show, don't tell"** library — real-world examples of the brand applied across digital and print, structured around the actual product categories on the website.

It's intended to grow over time. Where examples don't yet exist, this section defines the *categories* that need to be filled in as assets are produced. Once a category has approved examples, link or embed them here.

Real product structure

All applications should reflect the real product categories as they appear on **scudamores.com** at the time of writing. Don't invent products or rename existing ones — pull from the live site.

Category	Products
Chauffeured Tours	Private College Backs, Shared College Backs, Grantchester
Boat Hire (Self-hire)	Punt Hire (College Backs & Grantchester), Canoe Hire (Grantchester), Kayak Hire (Grantchester), Paddle Board Hire (Grantchester)
Punting Experiences	Gin Punting, Treasure Hunt, Afternoon Tea, Punt & Walk, Romantic & Wedding, Bat Safari, Champagne, Fireworks
Punting for Groups	School, Corporate, Hen Party, Celebration
Other	Gift Vouchers, Community

> Reminder: when designing for a specific product, always check the live site first to confirm the current name, copy, and positioning. Products and copy can change.

Seasonal variations

Every key application — posters, social, email, hero photography — should be planned across **all**

four seasons of the Cam:

- **Spring** (Mar–May): blossoms on the Backs, May Bumps, May Balls, ducklings, fresh greens
- **Summer** (Jun–Aug): peak season, long evenings, weddings, champagne, school groups
- **Autumn** (Sep–Nov): bat safari season ending, fireworks, low golden light, leaves on the water
- **Winter** (Dec–Feb): quieter river, frost on the punts, gift vouchers, Christmas (closed Christmas Day only)

The master palette holds across seasons; mood cues from the colour palette section guide which accents to lean on (Lantern Gold + Midnight for fireworks, Honey on Cream for weddings, etc.).

Digital applications

Application	What's needed	Status
Website — homepage	Hero with anchored tagline ("Where Cambridge goes punting"), product category cards, seasonal hero rotation	*Live — link example*
Website — product pages	One template applied across each product (chauffeured, hire, experiences, groups)	*Live — needs design audit for consistency*
Website — booking flow	In-product UI: forms, date pickers, basket, confirmation. Lucide icons via shadcn.	*Live — needs design audit*
Email — newsletter template	Header, hero image (16:9), section blocks, product cards, footer	🟡 *Template to formalise*
Email — booking confirmation	Tabular figures for booking ref, date, time, seat count; warm closing line consistent with voice	🟡 *Template to formalise*
Email — transactional (reminders, post-trip thank-you, gift voucher delivery)	Same template family as confirmation, simpler header	🟡 *Templates to formalise*
Instagram — feed (1:1)	Hero photography, product launches, seasonal moments, customer moments (with consent)	*Live @puntingcambridge — visual audit recommended*
Instagram — Stories & Reels (9:16)	Vertical-first photography, lower-third typography in Inter, brand watermark	*Live — needs template kit*

Application	What's needed	Status
Instagram — posters / static carousels (9:16, 4:5)	Product launches, weather updates, May Ball / fireworks announcements	*Live — needs template kit*
YouTube — channel art (2560×1440 master)	Hero shot of the Cam, brand mark, tagline	*Live @ScudamoresPunts — review recommended*
YouTube — thumbnails (16:9)	Strong hero photography, large legible Gill Sans Bold title, no clickbait styling	🟡 *Template kit to develop*
YouTube — end cards	Subscribe + next-video, brand mark, consistent across channel	🟡 *To develop*
Digital ads — paid social (1:1, 4:5, 9:16)	Hero photography, headline in Gill Sans Bold, Lantern Gold CTA, no exclamation-mark hard-sell	🟡 *Template kit to develop*
Digital ads — Google display (300×250, 728×90, 300×600, etc.)	Brand mark, photography, single clear headline, Lantern Gold CTA	🟡 *Template kit to develop*
Digital ads — retargeting	Same template family as display, with stronger product/booking CTA	🟡 *To develop*
Booking platform UI	Lucide icons, Inter type, navy + cream + Lantern Gold CTA accent	*Live — design audit recommended*
Internal — dashboards	shadcn defaults extended with brand palette per Charts section	*Live — extending with brand palette*
Internal — slide template (Google Slides / PowerPoint)	Title slide, section divider, content slide, chart slide, image slide, closing slide	🟡 *Template kit to develop*
Internal — docs (Notion / Google Docs)	Header style, body style, callout style, simple cover treatment	🟡 *Style guide to write*

Print applications

Application	What's needed	Status
Letterhead	A4, deep navy mark, Mill Lane address, contact details in Inter	🟡 *To produce*
Business cards	85×55mm, navy front with mark and Lantern Gold accent, cream reverse with details	🟡 *To produce*

Application	What's needed	Status
Compliments slips	DL format, brand mark, room for handwritten note	🟡 *To produce*
Tickets	Per-product (Chauffeured, Self-Hire, Experiences, Groups). Tabular figures for booking ref, date, time, seat.	🟡 *Audit existing, formalise*
Vouchers — gift vouchers	Premium feel: cream stock, Brass + Deep Navy, Gill Sans display	*Live — design audit recommended*
Gift cards	Sized for envelope, range of seasonal designs	🟡 *To develop*
Posters — product	One per product line. A2 / A3 vertical. Hero photography + Gill Sans headline.	🟡 *To produce per product*
Posters — event / seasonal	May Bumps, May Ball fireworks, Bat Safari season, Champagne evenings, Christmas vouchers	🟡 *Produce per season*
Signage — boatyard & Mill Lane	Wayfinding, pricing boards, opening times	*Live — design audit recommended*
Signage — on-river	Wayfinding for self-hire (turn here, return here, hazards)	*Live — design audit recommended*
Signage — punting stations (Mill Lane, Mill Lane Boatyard, Magdalene Bridge, Quayside)	Station identity, opening times, contact	*Live — needs consistency check*
Visitor brochures / leaflets	A5 or DL, product overview, map of the Backs, opening times	🟡 *To produce*
B2B partnership materials	A4 portrait, products + group offers + case studies	🟡 *To produce*
Merch — staff uniform	Branded waistcoats, hats, jumpers — chauffeur uniform per season	*Live — see Photography note on wardrobe*
Merch — branded items	Blankets, flasks, umbrellas (the small details on the punt)	*Live — see Photography subjects*
Wedding & private hire menus / programmes	Premium cream stock, Brass + Deep Navy, custom per booking	🟡 *Template to develop*

Application	What's needed	Status
Certificates (e.g. learn-to-punt, treasure hunt completion)	A4, watermark, Gill Sans display, room for handwritten name and date	🟡 *Template to develop*

Status legend

- ✅ **Live** — example exists, links/images attached
- 🟡 **To produce / formalise** — category defined, asset(s) not yet created or in need of design pass
- ⚠️ **Needs review** — exists but doesn't yet meet brand guidelines

How to use this section

1. **Before designing anything new**, look here first — there may already be a template or precedent.
2. **When you produce a new on-brand asset**, link or embed it under the relevant row and update the status to ✅.
3. **When you find an existing asset that's drifted off-brand**, mark it ⚠️ and flag for the team's next design review.
4. **For new applications not in this list** — propose them, get sign-off from the brand owner, then add a row.

Follow-ups

Items captured during the brand guidelines workshop that need follow-up work to fully complete:

1. **AI usage policy for branding, design and marketing** — to be defined as a separate workstream
2. **Scudamore's-isms vocabulary list** (in Brand voice) — needs team workshop to align on house terms (the Cam vs the river Cam, chauffeur vs guide, punt vs boat, named colleges, etc.)
3. **Event / seasonal logo variations** (in Logo) — guidelines for Bat Tours, Halloween, fireworks, etc., once the team has aligned on approach
4. **Custom icon set development** (in Graphics & icons) — bespoke punting and Cambridge-business icons; currently an ad-hoc mix of solid and outlined
5. **Illustration style** (in Graphics & icons) — placeholder; needs definition when the team decides to lean into illustration more

6. **Vintage imagery rights audit** (in Graphics & icons) — audit what we own outright vs what would need licensing, so we can make confident use of archival material
7. **Photography rights & consent** (in Photography) — confirm employment contracts cover image rights for staff; document the release form template; centralise storage of signed releases
8. **Email, slide and ad template kits** (in Brand applications) — multiple templates flagged 🟡 are ready for design production
9. **Existing assets audit** (in Brand applications) — items marked ⚠️ need a design pass to bring them into alignment with these guidelines

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End of guidelines.